

List of Kanji

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2	Lose (失)
3	Bow (弓)
4	Horse (馬)
5	Week (週)
6	Pull (引)

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漢字 1: Near (近)

近	近	
Near.		
The sense of “recent” is also incorporated.		

∈ Composition

Glyphs	斤 + 辵
English	Axe + Walk/Road

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Nearly	got [axed] while [walking].
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♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	キン (KIN)	ちか (chika)
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Near	<KINDRED> to us are the <chickadees>.
------	---------------------------------------

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
近い	<i>near</i>	ちかい (chikai)
近づく	<i>to approach</i>	ちかづく (chikazuku)
近道	near + road = <i>shortcut</i>	ちかみち (chika-michi)
近親	near + parent = <i>close relative</i>	キン・シン (KIN-SHIN)
最近	most + near = <i>recently</i>	サイ・キン (SAIKIN)

{...} Sample Sentence

新しい家は川の近くにあります。
atarashii ie wa kawa no chikaku ni arimasu.
(new) (house) (river) (near) (is)
= <i>The new house is near a river.</i>

漢字 2: Lose (失)

失	失	
Lose, in the sense of “mislay”.		
This character often conveys a hint of “failure and error”.		

∈ Composition

Glyphs	ノ + 二 + 人
English	Slash + Two + Person

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Lost	[two] [people] [slashing] each other.
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♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	シツ (SHITSU)	うしな (ushina)
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Lose	your <SHEETS> until <you shine>.
------	----------------------------------

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
失う	<i>to lose</i>	うしなう (ushinau)
見失う	see + lose = <i>to lose sight of</i>	み うしなう (mi ushinau)
失言	lose + say = <i>slip of the tongue</i>	シス・ゲン (SHITSU-GEN)

{...} Sample Sentence

大会で失言しました。
TAIKAI de SHITSU-GEN shimashita.
(convention) (slip of the tongue) (did)
= <i>(I) made a slip of the tongue at the convention.</i>

漢字 3: Bow (弓)

		
Bow (the partner to an arrow).		

∈ Composition

Glyphs	弓
English	Bow

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Part of the 漢字 radicals (#57).

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	キュウ (KYŪ)	ゆみ (yumi)
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

This **bow** will **⟨KILL YOU⟩** <yummily>.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
弓	<i>bow</i>	ゆみ (yumi)
弓道	bow + road = (Japanese) archery	キュウ・ドウ (KYŪ·DŌ)

{...} Sample Sentence

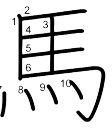
前田さんは古い弓と美しい日本刀を買いました。

Maeda-san wa furui yumi to utsukushii NIHON-TŌ o ka-imashita.

(Maeda-san) (old) (bow) (beautiful) (Japanese sword) (bought)

= Maeda-san bough an old bow and a beautiful Japanese sword.

漢字 4: Horse (馬)

		
Horse.		

∈ Composition

Glyphs	馬
English	Horse

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Part of the 漢字 radicals (#187).

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	バ (BA)	うま (uma)
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Horse -⟨**BUM**⟩ is <umami>.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
馬	<i>horse</i>	うま (uma)
子馬	child + horse = <i>colt</i> ; <i>pony</i>	こ・うま (kouma)
牛馬	cow + horse = <i>cows</i> and <i>horses</i>	ギユウ・バ (GYŪ·BA)
馬具	horse + tool = <i>harness</i>	バ・グ (BA·GU)

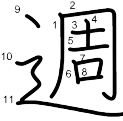
{...} Sample Sentence

馬と牛のどちらが好きですか。

uma to ushi no dochira ga suki desu ka.

(horse) (cow) (which) (like)

= Which do you like, horses or cows?

漢字 5: Week (週)		
		
Week.		
	∈ Composition	
Glyphs	周 + 辵	
English	Around (??) + Walk/Road	
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
Weeks	of 「walking」 「around」.	
	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	シュウ (SHŪ)	—
L.C.	—	—
♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
Weekly	〈SHOES〉.	

+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
週間	week + interval = <i>week</i>	シュウ・カン (SHŪ-KAN)
一週間	one + week + interval = <i>one week</i>	イチ・シュウ・カン (ISSHŪ-KAN)
二週間	two + week + interval = <i>two weeks</i>	ニ・シュウ・カン (NISHŪ-KAN)
週日	week + sun (day) = <i>weekday</i>	シュウ・ジツ (SHŪ-JITSU)
先週	precede + week = <i>last week</i>	セン・シュウ (SENSHŪ)
来週	come + week = <i>next week</i>	ライ・シュウ (RAISHŪ)
{...} Sample Sentence		
月曜日 から 二週間の夏休みです。		
GETSU-YŌ-bi kara NISHŪ-KAN no natsu yasumi desu.		
(Monday) (from) (two weeks) (summer vacation)		
= There's a two-week summer vacation from Monday.		

漢字 6: Pull (引)		
		
Pull.		
This character also conveys the idea of “attraction” (best seen in the fourth example), and the sense of “receding” and “withdrawing”.		
You will notice it frequently on signs; it indicates “pull” on doors, and “discount” when used with numbers.		
	∈ Composition	
Glyphs	弓 + 丨	
English	Bow + Line/Pole/Vertical stroke	
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
Pull	the [bow] in a straight [line].	
	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	イン (IN)	ひ (hi)
L.C.	—	—
♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
Pull	<heaps> of (INK).	

+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
As seen in the third example, this is another 漢字 that can act like 買. The 訓読み can also become voiced in the second position, as happens in the fifth compound.		
引く	<i>to pull</i>	ひく (hiku)
引き出す	pull + exit = <i>to withdraw (something)</i>	ひき だす (hiki dasu)
引出し	pull + exit = <i>a withdrawal; a drawer</i>	ひき だし (hiki dashi)
引力	pull + strength = <i>gravitation</i>	イン・リョク (INRYOKU)
万引き	ten thousand + pull = <i>shoplifter</i>	マン びき (MAN biki)
引き受ける	pull + receive = <i>to undertake</i>	ひき うける (hiki ukeru)
引き上げる	pull + upper = <i>to pull up</i>	ひき あげる (hiki ageru)
{...} Sample Sentence		
やっと 牛を川 から 引き上げました。		
yatto ushi o kawa kara hiki agemashita.		
(finally) (cow) (river) (from) (pulled up)		
= (We) finally pulled the cow from the river.		

漢字 7: Second (秒)

		
Second (of time or arc).		

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	禾 + 少
English	Two-branch tree/Grain + Few (??)

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Seconds	until a [few] [crops] remained.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ビョウ (BYŌ)	—
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Seconds until it will <BE YOURS>.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
一秒	one + second = <i>one second</i>	イチ・ビョウ (ICHI·BYŌ)
五秒	five + second = <i>five seconds</i>	ゴ・ビョウ (GO·BYŌ)
秒読み	second + read = <i>countdown</i>	ビョウ よみ (BYŌ yomi)

{...} Sample Sentence

Note that the sample sentence contains one of the less common on-yomi for 分 (Entry ??) in the compound 十五分.

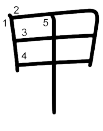
十五分 二十秒 かかりました。

JŪ-GO·FUN NIJŪ·BYŌ kakarimashita.

(fifteen minutes) (twenty seconds) (took)

=It took fifteen minutes and twenty seconds.

漢字 8: Shell (甲)

		
Shell.		
This character rarely appears on its own, but proves valuable as a component.		

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	田
English	Rice field

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Shells	in the [rice field].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	コウ (KŌ)	—
L.C.	カン (KAN)	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Shells <CAUSE> <CUNNING> schemes.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
手の甲	hand + shell = <i>back of the hand</i>	ての・コウ (teno·KŌ)

{...} Sample Sentence

上田さんは手の甲がかゆい。

Ueda-san wa teno·KŌ ga kayui.

(Ueda-san) (back of the hand) (itchy)

=The back of Ueda-san's hand is itchy.

漢字 9: Spirit (気)

Spirit. Air. Feeling. Mood.	
This 漢字 is found in many common words and expressions.	

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	气 + メ
English	Steam/Air + ME (katakana)

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Spirit	「men」 in the 「steam」 room.

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	キ (KI)	—
L.C.	ケ (KE)	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations	
Spirits	〈KILLING〉 〈KEGS〉.

+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
気	<i>spirit</i>	キ (KI)
元気	basis + spirit = <i>high spirits</i>	ゲン・キ (GEN-KI)
人気	person + spirit = <i>popularity</i>	ニン・キ (NIN-KI)
電気	electric + spirit = <i>electricity</i>	デン・キ (DEN-KI)
天気	heaven + spirit = <i>the weather</i>	テン・キ (TEN-KI)
気持ち	spirit + hold = <i>feeling</i>	キ も・ち (KI mochi)

{...} Sample Sentence	
The sample sentence is an extremely common greeting/question in 日本語.	
<u>元</u> 気ですか。	
GEN-KI desu ka.	
(high spirits)	
= <i>How are you?</i>	

漢字 10: Time (時)

Time.	
This character will become familiar to you through its use in the hours of the day (the third and fourth compounds below are examples).	

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	日 + 寺
English	Sun + Temple (??)

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Time	is calibrated in 「temples」 by means of the 「sun」.

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ジ (JI)	とき (toki)
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations	
Time	the 〈JIGGLING〉 <torque>.

+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
Note how the final half of the second compound becomes voiced; this is an occasional feature of repeated compounds.		
時	<i>time</i>	とき (toki)
時々	time + time = <i>sometimes</i>	とき・とき (toki-doki)
*四時	four + time = <i>four o' clock</i>	よ・ジ (yo-JI)
九時半	nine + time + half = <i>nine-thirty</i>	ク・ジ・ハン (KU-JIHAN)
同時	same + time = <i>simultaneous</i>	ドウ・ジ (DŌ-JI)

** Irregular Reading(s)		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
時計	time + measure = <i>watch; clock</i>	と・ケイ (to-KEI)

{...} Sample Sentence	
<u>八時半</u> に <u>東口</u> の <u>近く</u> で <u>会</u> いましょう。	
HACHIJIHAN ni higashiguchi no chikaku de aimashō.	
(eight-thirty) (east entrance) (near) (let's meet)	
= <i>Let's meet near the east entrance at eight-thirty.</i>	

漢字 11: Speak (話)

話

話

Speak, along with the ideas of “conversations” and “stories”.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	言 + 舌
English	Say/Speaking/Speech + Tongue

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

“Speak”, [says] the [tongue].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ワ (WA)	はなし、はな (hanashi, hana)

As in the final example below, the 訓読み for this 漢字 is always voiced in the second position.

L.C.	—	—
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♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Speak how <hung-up> <Hanah shielded> us from being <WASHED>.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
話	story	はなし (hanashi)
話す	to speak	はなす (hanasu)
話し好き	speak + like = talkative	はなし ずき (hanashi zuki)
電話	electric + speak = telephone	デン・ワ (DEN-WA)
会話	meet + speak = conversation	カイ・ワ (KAI-WA)
立ち話	stand + speak = chatting while standing	たち ばなし (tachi banashi)

{...} Sample Sentence

田中さんはフランス語を上手に話せます。

Tanaka-san wa FuransoGO o JŌzu ni hanasemasu.

(Tanaka-san) (French) (well) (can speak)

= Tanaka-san can speak French well.

漢字 12: English (英)

英

英

English.

A secondary meaning relates to “brilliance”.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	艸 + 央
English	Grass + Center (??)

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Brilliant English [grass] is [central].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	エイ (EI)	—
L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

English <AIM> for world domination.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
英語	English + words = English language	エイ・ゴ (EIGO)
英国	English + country = England	エイ・コク (EIKOKU)
英会話	English + meet + speak = English conversation	エイ・カイ・ワ (EIKAI-WA)
日英	sun + English = Japan and England	ニチ・エイ (NICHIEI)

{...} Sample Sentence

英会話は日本で人気があります。

EIKAIWA wa NIHON de NIN-KI ga arimasu.

(English conversation) (Japan) (popular) (is)

= English conversation is popular in Japan.

漢字 13: Instruction (訓)

訓		
Instruction. This 漢字 tends to give a more serious or spiritual sense of “teaching” to the compounds in which it appears.		

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	言 + 川
English	Say/Speaking/Speech + River

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Instruct the [river] to [say] something.

	♪ Pronunciations
	音読み 訓読み
Cm.	クン (KUN) —
L.C.	— —

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations
Instruct the <RACCOON>?!

+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
訓読み	instruction + read = <i>the kun-yomi</i>	クン よみ (KUN yomi)
訓話	instruction + speak = <i>moral discourse</i>	クンワ (KUN-WA)

{...} Sample Sentence
これを訓読みで読んで下さい。
kore o KUN-yomi de yonde kudasai.
(this) (kun-yomi) (read) (please)
= Please read this with kun-yomi.

漢字 14: Push (押)

押		
Push. Suppression. Restraint. This 漢字 also serves as the partner to 引 (Entry 6) on door signs.		

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	手 + 田
English	Hand + Rice field

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Push your [hand] into the [rice fields].

	♪ Pronunciations
	音読み 訓読み
Cm.	— お (o)
L.C.	オウ (OU) —

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations
Pushing can be <AWEFULLY> <obligatory>.

+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
As indicated by the last two examples below, this is another 漢字 that often shows up in the manner of 買.		
押す	to push	おす (osu)
押し出す	push + exit = <i>to push out</i>	おし だす (oshi dasu)
押し上げる	push + upper = <i>to push up</i>	おし あげる (oshi ageru)
押し開ける	push + open = <i>to push open</i>	おし あける (oshi akeru)
押入れ	push + enter = <i>closet</i>	おし いれ (oshi ire)
押売	push + sell = <i>high-pressure sales</i>	おしうり (oshiuri)

{...} Sample Sentence
押入れの中に物が少ない。
oshi ire no naka ni mono ga sukunai.
(closet) (middle) (things) (few)
= There aren't many things in the closet.

漢字 15: Year (年)

年	年	
Year.		

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	干 + 丿 + 一
English	Dry + Slash + One

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Year	[one] [dries] out in a [slash].

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ネン (NEN)	とし (toshi)
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations
The year the <NENETS> acquired <Toshiba>.
‡Nenets is an ethnic group native to Northern Arctic Russia.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
年	year	とし (toshi)
年上	year + upper = older	とし・うえ (toshi-ue)
年下	year + lower = younger	としした (toshishita)
新年	new + year = the New year	シン・ネン (SHIN-NEN)
中年	middle + year = middle age	チュウ・ネン (CHŪ-NEN)
一年生	one + year + life = first-year student	イチ・ネン・セイ (ICHINENSEI)

{...} Sample Sentence

青木さんは三年生です。
Aoki-san wa SAN-NEN-SEI desu.
(Aoki-san) (third-year student)
= Aoki-san is a third-year student.

漢字 16: Come (来)

来	来	
Come.		
As the final four compounds below make clear, the related meanings of “next” is also included.		

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	一 + 米
English	One + Rice

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Come	「one」 「rice」 grain at a time.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	アイ (RAI)	く (ku)
L.C.	—	き、こ (ki, ko)

This character is infamous for being one of the only two irregular verbs in Japanese. The character can be read variously as く, き, or こ, depending on which tense of the verb is being used. The sample sentence offers an example of the polite past tense. Note, however, an important exception in the second compound below (an extremely common word); when following the 漢字 出, 来 is always read き.

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Come up with a <coup> to <keep> on <RHYMING> with <cobble>.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
来る	to come	く・る (ku·ru)
出来る	exit + come = to be able to	で きる (de kiru)
来週	come + week = next week	ライ・シュウ (RAISHŪ)
来月	come + moon = next month	ライ・ゲツ (RAIGETSU)
来年	come + year = next year	ライ・ネン (RAINEN)
来春	come + spring = next spring	ライ・シュン (RAISHUN)

{...} Sample Sentence

先生は一週間前に来ました。
SENSEI wa ISSHŪ-KAN mae ni kimashita.
(teacher) (one week) (before) (came)
= The teacher came a week ago.

漢字 17: Study (学)

学	学	
Study. Learning.		
When used as a suffix, it is often equivalent to the English “-ology”. The final compound offers such an example.		

∈ Composition		
Glyphs	子 + 小 ^ㇰ ^ㇱ + 冫	
English	Child + Small + Cover/Crown	

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Study	the [small] [crowns] of [children].

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ガク (GAKU)	まな (mana)
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Study	how to <manage> all this <GUCK>.
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+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
学ぶ	<i>to study</i>	まなぶ (mana-bu)
大学	large + study = <i>university</i>	ダイ・ガク (DAI-GAKU)
学生	study + life = <i>student</i>	ガク・セイ (GAKU-SEI)
休学	rest + study = <i>absence from school</i>	キュウ・ガク (KYŪ-GAKU)
語学	words + study = <i>linguistics</i>	ゴ・ガク (GO-GAKU)
生物学	life + thing + study = <i>biology</i>	セイ・ブツ・ガク (SEIBUTSU-GAKU)

{...} Sample Sentence	
この家には大学生が多い。	
kono ie ni wa DAIGAKU-SEI ga ōi.	
(this) (house) (university students) (many)	
= <i>There are many university students in this house.</i>	

漢字 18: Mind (意)

意	意	
Mind. Thought.		
This abstract character appears in many compounds conveying the ideas of “will”, “intention”, and “opinion”, etc.		

∈ Composition		
Glyphs	音 + 心	
English	Sound + Heart	

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Mind	[resonating] with [heart].

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	イ (I)	—
L.C.	—	—

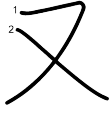
♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Mind	the <INDICATORS>.
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+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
意思	mind + think = <i>(one's) intent</i>	イ・シ (ISHI)
意図	mind + diagram = <i>(one's) aim</i>	イ・ト (ITO)
意外	mind + outside = <i>unforeseen</i>	イ・ガイ (IGAI)
*意見	mind + see = <i>opinion</i>	イ・ケン (IKEN)
意気	mind + spirit = <i>morale</i>	イ・キ (IKI)
注意	pour + mind = <i>attention</i>	チュウ・イ (CHŪ-I)

{...} Sample Sentence	
あなたの意見が分かりません。	
anata no IKEN ga wakarimasen.	
(you) (opinion) (don't understand)	
= <i>I don't understand your opinion.</i>	

漢字 19: Again (又)

		
Again. Also.		
A character that rarely appears on its own.		
The suggested immediate visual connection is “ironing board”.		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	又
English	Again

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Part of the 漢字 radicals (#29).

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	—	また (mata)
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Again	and again the <matador> irked the bull.
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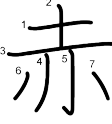
+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
又	<i>again</i>	また (mata)
又々	again + again = <i>once again</i>	またまた (matamata)
又聞き	again + hear = <i>hearsay</i>	またぎき (matagiki)

{...} Sample Sentence

The pronunciation of 来なかった in this sample sentence, incidentally, is the informal past tense reading of 来。	
北川さんは又 来なかったよ。	
Kitagawa-san wa mata konakatta yo.	
(Kitagawa-san) (again) (didn't come)	
= Kitagawa-san didn't come again!	

漢字 20: Red (赤)

		
Red.		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	赤
English	Red

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Part of the 漢字 radicals (#155).

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	セキ (SEKI)	あか (aka)
L.C.	シャク (SHAKU)	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Red	is <also known as> <SEXY>. <SHUCKS>!
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+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
赤	<i>red (noun)</i>	あか (aka)
赤い	<i>red (adjective)</i>	あかい (akai)
赤ちゃん	<i>baby</i>	あかちゃん (akachan)
赤道	red + road = <i>equator</i>	セキドウ (SEKIDŌ)

{...} Sample Sentence

あの 赤い 花は美しい ですね。	
ano akai hana wa utsukushii desu ne.	
(that) (red) (flower) (beautiful) (isn't it)	
= That red flower is beautiful, isn't it?	

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漢字 by Stroke Count

2 Strokes		5 Strokes		赤	12	10 Strokes	
又	12	失	3	8 Strokes		時	7
3 Strokes		甲	6	学	11	訓	9
弓	4	6 Strokes		押	9	馬	4
4 Strokes		年	10	英	8	11 Strokes	
引	5	氣	7	9 Strokes		週	5
近	3	7 Strokes		秒	6	13 Strokes	
		来	10			意	11
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